

POLAND

ASYMMETRIC IDEAS REPORT

Warsaw Stock Exchange (WSE) — March 2026

Six high-conviction asymmetric opportunities across six independent sectors, each with a distinct mispricing *mechanism*, a distinct *catalyst*, and a hard downside floor. Together they form a diversified Polish alpha portfolio exploiting five structural forces: MSCI reclassification, NATO rearmament, CHF resolution, energy transition mandate, and persistent language/information barriers.

#	Company	Ticker	Sector	Mkt Cap €m	Entry	Bear	Base	Bull	PW Ret%	Asym
1	Lubawa SA	LBW	Defense / Protective Equ	€133m	8.12	5.00	18.00	38.00	+171.6%	9.6×
2	Agora SA	AGO	Diversified Media / OOH	€74m	8.94	5.50	22.00	45.00	+173.5%	10.5×
3	mBank SA	MBK	Digital Banking	€8,700m	1013.00	700.00	1350.00	1750.00	+30.3%	2.4×
4	Mirbud SA	MRB	Construction / Infrastru	€77m	3.80	2.80	7.20	10.50	+102.5%	6.7×
5	Onde SA	ONDP	Renewable Energy EPC / G	€111m	10.10	6.50	18.00	32.00	+90.1%	6.1×
6	Polimex-Mostostal SA	PXM	Industrial Construction	€152m	3.28	1.20	9.00	16.00	+156.4%	6.1×

PW Ret% = probability-weighted return. Asym = bull upside ÷ bear downside. All prices in PLN. This report is for professional investors only.

SECTION 1 — WHY POLAND NOW

Five structural forces converge in 2026 to make the Warsaw Stock Exchange one of Europe's most fertile markets for asymmetric investing. These forces are **independent** of each other — they do not all have to materialise for the thesis to work.

1 MSCI Reclassification Q2 2026

Poland moves from Emerging to Developed Markets. Passive DM funds are forced buyers of ALL Polish listed names. Institutional infrastructure (active desks, research) follows passive flows.

2 NATO Defense Super-Cycle

Poland commits 5% of GDP to defense — highest in NATO. \$301.6bn over 2026-2030, +118% vs prior five years. Defense sub-contractors still priced as industrial commodities vs Rheinmetall (30×), Thales (22×).

3 CHF Mortgage Resolution

Polish banks provisioned PLN 150bn+ since 2019. Provision costs fell >50% YoY in 2025 for leading banks. Sector-wide discount is now larger than the remaining tail risk.

4 Energy Transition Mandate

EU law: 42.5% renewables by 2030 (Poland at ~25% today). PSE grid capex PLN 30bn, 5.9 GW offshore wind. The infrastructure pipeline is signed and funded — not speculative.

5 Language / Information Barrier

Median WSE mid-cap analyst coverage: 2 (vs 8+ for German peers). All filings in Polish only. Information asymmetry directly translates to price asymmetry. Reading Polish is the edge.

WSE STRUCTURAL CHARACTERISTICS

400

listed companies; similar scale to Vienna or Oslo

<15
%

median institutional ownership on WSE mid-caps

60%
+

of mid-caps are founder/family controlled

2

median analyst coverage for WSE mid-caps (vs 8+ for German peers)

3 da
ys

EU MAR insider reporting window via ESPI — first-mover advantage

PLN
/EU
R

language barrier creates persistent information asymmetry = alpha

SECTION 2 — WHAT MAKES THESE IDEAS ASYMMETRIC

A genuine asymmetric idea is **not** simply a cheap stock. It requires three elements simultaneously:

A

MECHANISM

A specific, identifiable reason the stock is mispriced — size exclusion, language barrier, conglomerate discount, binary event overhang, accounting distortion.

B

CATALYST

A specific event that forces price discovery. Without a catalyst, cheap stocks stay cheap indefinitely. The catalyst can be internal (M&A, earnings) or external (regulatory, macro, ownership change).

C

FLOOR

An independently derivable downside limit that holds regardless of whether the catalyst materialises — asset value, replacement cost, backlog value, or regulatory entitlement.

IDEA TYPE MATRIX — HOW EACH IDEA IS MISPRICED

Company	Mispricing Mechanism	Catalyst	Floor
Lubawa (LBW)	Size exclusion (€133m) + zero English IR. Market treats it as textile, not defense.	First institutional 5% crossing (ESPI disclosure). First English broker note.	Net cash + backlog > market cap. Entry below asset value.
Agora (AGO)	Conglomerate discount. GW newspaper 'poisons' perception of OOH business.	AMS partial sale or strategic review. EBITDA > PLN 150m print.	AMS alone at 6× EV/EBITDA covers full market cap twice.
mBank (MBK)	CHF overhang over-provisioned. Parent (Commerzbank) = forced seller if UniCredit wins.	CHF costs < PLN 100m/qtr. UniCredit AGM 2026 re Commerzbank.	Book value PLN 830/share vs entry PLN 1,013 (cushion).
Mirbud (MRB)	Road contractor perception ignores rail option and land bank at 0.61× book.	PKP PLK tender award. Land bank disposal/JV announcement.	Land bank at historical cost > PLN 230m. Book value > entry.
Onde (ONDP)	Generic EPC contractor perception despite locked-in regulatory pipeline.	PSE framework contract. Offshore wind pre-qualification.	Legally mandated EU energy pipeline = quasi-regulatory floor.
Polimex (PXM)	Operating losses obscure nuclear pre-qualification option (priced at zero).	Polish govt FID on Lubiatowo-Kopalino. Westinghouse EPC contract.	Revenue base PLN 2.86bn + nuclear civil works = USD 1–3.2bn option.

SECTION 3 — SIX IDEAS IN DETAIL

#1

Lubawa SA

LBW WSE | Defense / Protective Equipment

Micro-Cap Neglect + Defense

Conviction: **HIGH** | Horizon: **12–24 months**

KEY METRICS

Market Cap	PLN 658m / €133m
Entry Price	PLN 8.12
P/E	5.9×
P/Book	1.27×
ROE	+29.5%
EBITDA Margin	24.3%
Revenue PLNm	510m
	YoY: +52%
Insider %	51.2%
Institutional %	0.0%
Analyst Coverage	0 analyst (s)

WHY IT IS ASYMMETRIC

Poland's #1 ballistic-protection maker. ROE 29%, margins 24%, revenue +52% YoY, net cash. European defense peers trade at 15–30× EV/EBITDA. Lubawa trades at 3.8×. The gap is 100% mechanical: zero institutional ownership (size exclusion at €133m) and zero English IR. One investor crossing 5% triggers the discovery cascade. Entry is below the hard asset floor (net cash + backlog).

Asymmetry note: You buy at a discount to floor. Bull/Bear ratio: 9.6×

CATALYST

First institutional buyer crosses 5% (ESPI disclosure); first English broker note; MSCI DM reclassification passive flows

KEY RISKS

Founder 51% control / no IR pressure; defense budget shifts to hardware (tanks) vs. soldier equipment; thin free float

SCENARIO ANALYSIS

Scenario	Target	Return	Prob
BULL	PLN 38.00	+368%	30%
BASE	PLN 18.00	+122%	55%
BEAR	PLN 5.00	-38%	15%
PW RETURN		+171.6%	

Asymmetry ratio: **9.6×**

(Bull upside ÷ Bear downside)

2

Agora SA

AGO WSE | Diversified Media / OOH Advertising

SOTP Conglomerate Discount

Conviction: **HIGH** | Horizon: **24–36 months**

KEY METRICS

Market Cap	PLN 367m / €74m
Entry Price	PLN 8.94
P/Book	1.19×
ROE	+4.5%
EBITDA Margin	6.5%
Revenue PLNm	1,480m
	YoY: +7%
Insider %	22.0%
Institutional %	30.0%
Analyst Coverage	4 analyst (s)

WHY IT IS ASYMMETRIC

Poland's #1 outdoor advertiser (AMS) is worth PLN 999m at 9× EV/EBITDA — yet the entire Agora group trades at PLN 367m. AMS alone covers market cap 2.7×. Helios (54 cinemas), Radio Eurozet, Gazeta Wyborcza digital (300k+ paid subs) are free. The newspaper 'poisons' the perception. One strategic sale or spin-off of AMS collapses the 3.7× SOTP-to-market-cap gap instantly.

Asymmetry note: SOTP base NAV PLN 1,350m vs market cap PLN 367m = 3.68× coverage.

CATALYST

AMS partial sale announcement (JCDecaux / Clear Channel approach); group EBITDA > PLN 150m print; PE buyout approach

KEY RISKS

Founding family has no financial pressure to unlock value; GW print accelerates decline; IFRS 16 inflates AMS EBITDA; EBITDA target missed

SCENARIO ANALYSIS

Scenario	Target	Return	Prob
BULL	PLN 45.00	+403%	25%
BASE	PLN 22.00	+146%	55%
BEAR	PLN 5.50	-38%	20%
PW RETURN		+173.5%	

Asymmetry ratio: **10.5×**

(Bull upside ÷ Bear downside)

3

mBank SA

MBK WSE | Digital Banking

Parent Disposition + CHF Resolution

Conviction: **HIGH** | Horizon: **12–24 months**

KEY METRICS

	PLN
	43,079m
	/
Market Cap	€8,700m
	PLN
Entry Price	1013.00
P/E	12.4×
P/Book	1.22×
ROE	+16.4%
Insider %	1.0%
Institutional %	20.0%
	12 analyst(s)
Analyst Coverage	

WHY IT IS ASYMMETRIC

Poland's best digital bank: ROE 16.4%, cost-to-income <30%, fully digital-native. Should trade at a premium — trades at a discount solely due to CHF mortgage overhang. CHF costs fell >50% YoY in 2025. Thesis 1: CHF resolves → P/E expands from 12.4× to 14–16×. Thesis 2: UniCredit acquires Commerzbank (69% MBK owner) → forced mBank sale at 1.4–1.5× P/BV. Two independent theses; each alone justifies entry.

Asymmetry note: Two independent theses; only lose if BOTH CHF escalates AND M&A; collapses.

CATALYST

CHF provisions < PLN 100m/qtr for 2 consecutive quarters; UniCredit AGM May 2026 re Commerzbank; German govt stake sale in CBK

KEY RISKS

New Supreme Court ruling expanding CHF liability; UniCredit-Commerzbank deal collapse; Polish rate cuts compressing NIM; UniCredit retains mBank

SCENARIO ANALYSIS

Scenario	Target	Return	Prob
BULL	PLN 1750.00	+73%	25%
BASE	PLN 1350.00	+33%	55%
BEAR	PLN 700.00	-31%	20%
PW RETURN		+30.3%	

Asymmetry ratio: **2.4×**

(Bull upside ÷ Bear downside)

4

Mirbud SA

MRB WSE | Construction / Infrastructure

Hidden Asset + Rail Pivot

Conviction: **MEDIUM+** | Horizon: **18–36 months**

KEY METRICS

	PLN 380m / €77m
Market Cap	
Entry Price	PLN 3.80
P/Book	0.61×
ROE	+7.5%
EBITDA Margin	5.5%
Revenue PLNm	2,100m
	YoY: +8%
Insider %	62.0%
Institutional %	8.0%
	2 analyst (s)
Analyst Coverage	

WHY IT IS ASYMMETRIC

Road contractor priced as a commodity at 0.61× book. Two embedded options: (1) Land bank at historical cost — independent property value = 1.5–2× book, provides a hard floor above current price. (2) Rail pivot — pre-qualified for PKP PLK tenders worth PLN 135bn. Rail margins (12–15% EBITDA) are 2–3× road margins. Market assigns zero probability to the pivot. Even a 6% win rate in tenders creates PLN 936m of incremental value vs PLN 380m market cap.

Asymmetry note: Land bank alone worth ~PLN 230m. Rail option is genuinely free.

CATALYST

PKP PLK tender award via ESPI; land bank disposal or JV announcement; rail revenue > 10% of total

KEY RISKS

Rail tendering delayed (CEF administrative process); road margin compression; labour cost inflation; no activist pressure with 62% founder stake

SCENARIO ANALYSIS

Scenario	Target	Return	Prob
BULL	PLN 10.50	+176%	35%
BASE	PLN 7.20	+89%	50%
BEAR	PLN 2.80	-26%	15%
PW RETURN		+102.5 %	

Asymmetry ratio: **6.7×**

(Bull upside ÷ Bear downside)

5

Onde SA

ONDP WSE | Renewable Energy EPC / Grid

Pipeline Certainty + Energy Mandate

Conviction: **MEDIUM+** | Horizon: **18–30 months**

KEY METRICS

Market Cap	PLN 550m / €111m
Entry Price	PLN 10.10
P/Book	1.29×
ROE	+5.5%
EBITDA Margin	7.0%
Revenue PLNm	804m
	YoY: +12%
Insider %	52.0%
Institutional %	9.0%
	3 analyst (s)
Analyst Coverage	

WHY IT IS ASYMMETRIC

Specialist EPC contractor for Polish renewables and grid infrastructure. Poland has a legally binding mandate: 42.5% renewables by 2030 vs 25% today. PSE capex: PLN 30bn through 2032. Onde is one of 4–5 pre-qualified contractors. The pipeline is not speculative — it is signed and funded. Market prices Onde as a generic contractor (1.3× book). European renewable EPC peers trade at 2.0–3.5× book. The gap is purely discovery and language barrier.

Asymmetry note: Regulatory mandate is the floor. Miss on execution = only downside.

CATALYST

New PSE grid framework contract award; offshore wind pre-qualification; Polish RES Act 2032 extension; order book > PLN 3bn

KEY RISKS

PSE grid connection bottlenecks; PGE in-house construction competition; EU fund disbursement delays; project finance rate sensitivity

SCENARIO ANALYSIS

Scenario	Target	Return	Prob
BULL	PLN 32.00	+217%	25%
BASE	PLN 18.00	+78%	55%
BEAR	PLN 6.50	-36%	20%
PW RETURN		+90.1%	

Asymmetry ratio: **6.1×**

(Bull upside ÷ Bear downside)

6

Polimex-Mostostal SA

PXM WSE | Industrial Construction / Nuclear

Binary Nuclear Option

Conviction: **OPTION** | Horizon: **24–48 months**

KEY METRICS

Market Cap	PLN 754m / €152m
Entry Price	PLN 3.28
P/Book	1.73×
ROE	-55.0%
EBITDA Margin	-3.0%
Revenue PLNm	2,860m
	YoY: -5%
Insider %	8.0%
Institutional %	22.0%
Analyst Coverage	5 analyst (s)

WHY IT IS ASYMMETRIC

Poland's largest industrial contractor — currently loss-making, hence the price. Hidden within: pre-qualification for Poland's first nuclear power plant (Lubiatowo-Kopalino, 2× AP1000, USD 20–40bn total). Civil works alone: USD 4–8bn. Polimex realistic share: 25–40% = USD 1–3.2bn over 8 years, against a current revenue base of PLN 2.86bn/year. Market cap = PLN 754m. The nuclear option is priced at essentially zero. Size it as a call option (1–2% of portfolio), not a core holding.

Asymmetry note: Single biggest infrastructure project in Polish history.
Option = free.

CATALYST

Polish govt FID on Lubiatowo-Kopalino nuclear plant; EPC contract signature with Westinghouse; EBITDA return to positive (operational turnaround)

KEY RISKS

Nuclear further delayed or cancelled; operating losses deteriorate balance sheet; international contractors displace Polimex in consortium; loss of pre-qualification

SCENARIO ANALYSIS

Scenario	Target	Return	Prob
BULL	PLN 16.00	+388%	25%
BASE	PLN 9.00	+174%	45%
BEAR	PLN 1.20	-63%	30%
PW RETURN		+156.4 %	

Asymmetry ratio: **6.1×**

(Bull upside ÷ Bear downside)

SECTION 4 — PORTFOLIO CONSTRUCTION

The six ideas span six independent sectors and six distinct mispricing types. Correlation between them is low — owning all six does not concentrate the bet.

SUGGESTED SIZING (% of dedicated Poland allocation)

#	Company	Weight	Rationale
1	mBank (MBK)	25–30%	Liquid (€8.7bn), dual thesis, near-term catalyst
2	Lubawa (LBW)	20–25%	Highest conviction; build slowly over 3–6 months (illiquid)
3	Agora (AGO)	15–20%	Clear SOTP floor; patience required for catalyst
4	Onde (ONDP)	10–15%	Thematic; pipeline certainty supports allocation
5	Mirbud (MRB)	8–12%	Deep value + rail option
6	Polimex (PXM)	5–8%	Binary option sizing — treat like a call, not a bond

EXIT DISCIPLINES

Lubawa (LBW)	Exit if institutional ownership crosses 15% — discovery complete.
Agora (AGO)	Exit if AMS is sold (SOTP realised); hold residual for Helios/Radio.
mBank (MBK)	Exit at M&A; bid +5% (spread trade) or PLN 1,450 (CHF-only thesis).
Mirbud (MRB)	Exit if rail backlog crosses PLN 1bn confirmed awards.
Onde (ONDP)	Exit when PSE framework contracts convert to revenue (2–3 years).
Polimex (PXM)	Exit at nuclear FID — option value crystallises fast post-announcement.

COMMON RISKS TO THE ENTIRE THESIS

■ PLN Currency	All six positions are PLN-denominated. Hedge via EUR/PLN forward if exposure > €20m.
■ Polish Politics	Government can weaponise sector taxes (bank levy, media law). Most acute for mBank and Agora.
■ EU Fund Delays	Poland holds €76bn of EU funds. Disbursement delays slow Mirbud / Onde / Polimex pipeline.
■ Rate Environment	Aggressive NBP rate cuts compress mBank NIM (partially offset by CHF resolution).
■ Global Risk-Off	CEE names sell first in global selloffs. Size for 18–36 month horizon, not 3-month trades.

SECTION 5 — MONITORING GRID & VERDICT

Company	Signal to Monitor	Data Source
Lubawa (LBW)	Foreign entity >5% stake (ESPI)	gpw.pl/espi-ebi-reports → LBW
Lubawa (LBW)	First English investor presentation	lubawa.pl/investor-relations
Lubawa (LBW)	First broker research note (any language)	Bloomberg BN LUBAWA
Agora (AGO)	Strategic review / AMS sale approach	agora.pl ESPI section
Agora (AGO)	EBITDA quarterly trend vs PLN 150m target	agora.pl/en/investor-relations
mBank (MBK)	CHF cost per quarter < PLN 100m	mbank.pl/en/investor-relations
mBank (MBK)	UniCredit AGM re Commerzbank (May 2026)	Bloomberg: UCG IM Equity
mBank (MBK)	German govt stake sale in Commerzbank	Bundesanzeiger + Bloomberg
Mirbud (MRB)	PKP PLK tender result (ESPI)	przetargi.gov.pl → Mirbud
Mirbud (MRB)	Land disposal / JV announcement	mirbud.pl ESPI
Onde (ONDP)	PSE framework contract award	pse.pl/en + ESPI ONDP
Onde (ONDP)	Offshore wind pre-qualification	pse.pl / orlen.pl
Polimex (PXM)	Nuclear FID announcement	gov.pl/web/nuclear-energy
Polimex (PXM)	Westinghouse consortium EPC update	Bloomberg: PXM PW Equity

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FINAL VERDICT — RANKED BY PROBABILITY-WEIGHTED RETURN

Rank	Company	Ticker	Idea Type	PW Ret%	Conviction	Horizon
1	Agora SA	AGO	SOTP Conglomerate Discount	+173.5%	HIGH	24–36 months
2	Lubawa SA	LBW	Micro-Cap Neglect + Defense	+171.6%	HIGH	12–24 months
3	Polimex-Mostostal SA	PXM	Binary Nuclear Option	+156.4%	OPTION	24–48 months
4	Mirbud SA	MRB	Hidden Asset + Rail Pivot	+102.5%	MEDIUM+	18–36 months
5	Onde SA	ONDP	Pipeline Certainty + Energy Mandate	+90.1%	MEDIUM+	18–30 months
6	mBank SA	MBK	Parent Disposition + CHF Resolution	+30.3%	HIGH	12–24 months

Overall Assessment. Poland in Q1 2026 offers a rare confluence of structural inflows (MSCI reclassification), a defense super-cycle not yet priced into sub-contractors, a banking sector CHF overhang that is definitively resolving, and an energy transition mandate that is legally binding and funded. The six companies in this report are not random cheap stocks — each has a specific named mispricing mechanism, a specific named catalyst, and a hard downside floor. The edge: you read Polish. Most of the competition does not.

DISCLAIMER: This report is for informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice. All figures are illustrative and based on publicly available data. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Invest only what you can afford to lose. For professional investors only.

